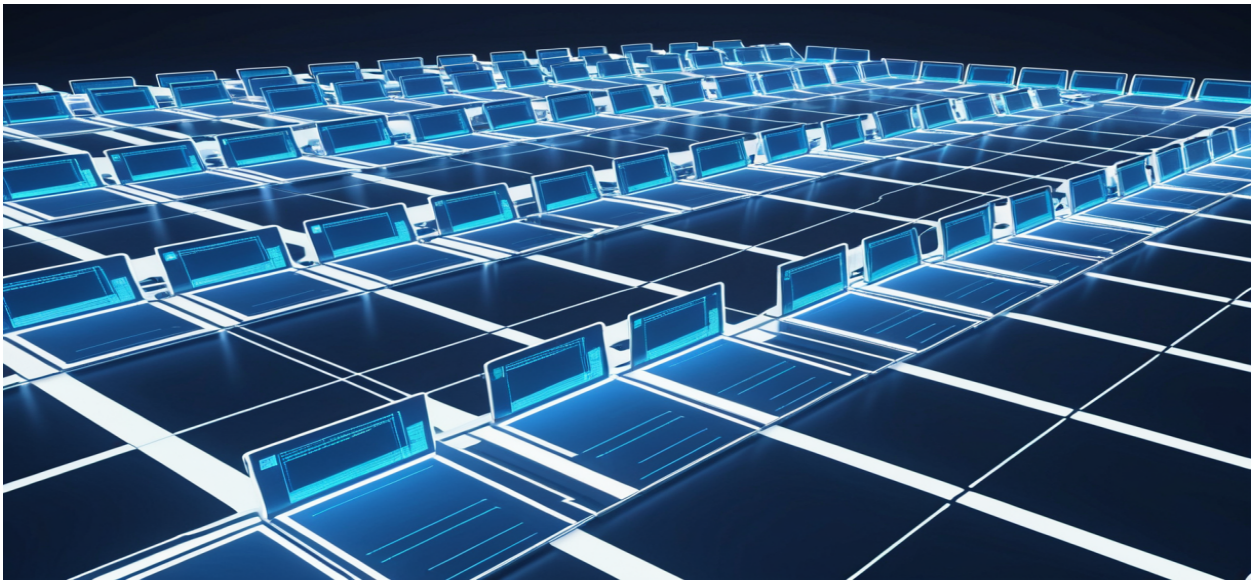

PRESS RELEASE

Research Shows How DAOs Can Process Proposals Faster Without Sacrificing Quality

Simulation study identifies optimal settings for temp-checks, fast-tracks, and voting windows

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

Key Findings:

- Temp-checks with 20-30% thresholds filter bad proposals while avoiding false rejections
- Fast-track mechanisms work best at 70% support threshold—higher is too restrictive
- 30-day proposal expiry windows cause excessive abandonment; 60 days is optimal
- Moderate pipeline settings consistently outperform both "no filtering" and "aggressive filtering"

The Problem: Governance Bottlenecks

Every DAO proposal must traverse a pipeline—a series of stages from initial idea to final execution. Design this pipeline poorly, and you get either gridlock (proposals languishing indefinitely) or rubber-stamping (inadequate deliberation on important decisions).

New research provides the first systematic analysis of how pipeline parameters affect governance outcomes, offering evidence-based guidance for a fundamental operational challenge.

The Pipeline Components Tested

The study examined three common pipeline mechanisms:

Temp-Checks: Preliminary "signal votes" (often off-chain via Snapshot) that filter proposals before formal governance. High temp-check thresholds reduce the load on formal voting but risk rejecting worthy proposals that lack initial awareness.

Fast-Tracks: Expedited paths for proposals with overwhelming early support. These accelerate uncontroversial decisions but may bypass deliberation on consequential issues.

Expiry Windows: Maximum time allowed for proposal resolution. Tight windows prevent stale proposals but may force premature decisions on complex initiatives.

What the Simulations Revealed

Across 270 simulation runs testing different pipeline configurations, the research identified clear patterns:

Temp-checks improve quality at acceptable cost. A 20-30% support threshold filters most low-quality proposals while passing the vast majority of ultimately viable initiatives. Thresholds above 40% filter too aggressively.

Fast-tracks should target clear consensus. A 70% early support threshold effectively identifies uncontroversial proposals suitable for expedited processing. At 85%, almost no proposals qualify.

Expiry windows need flexibility. 30-day windows cause excessive abandonment—proposers give up on complex initiatives. 60-day windows provide adequate time while preventing indefinite accumulation.

Moderate settings dominate extremes. Both "no filtering" and "aggressive filtering" underperform balanced approaches.

Design Principles for Practitioners

Based on the results, the research recommends:

1. **Filter early, filter gently:** Use temp-checks with moderate thresholds
2. **Accelerate consensus, not controversy:** Fast-track only proposals with clear supermajority support
3. **Bound but don't compress:** Set expiry windows that prevent accumulation but allow adequate deliberation
4. **Make stages meaningful:** Each pipeline stage should add information value

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Paper: "Proposal Pipeline Design in Decentralized Governance"

Code: https://github.com/imgntn/dao_simulator

This research was conducted independently and is released to advance the field of decentralized governance.